Milestone 1

Problem Definition

AI Role: Clarifier

#Ritual vs. Automation #Systems & Environment #Project Framing

Selected Key Prompt

"Üzerinde düşündüğüm şey şu tasarımcı olarak insanların hayatını kolaylaştırıyoruz evet kısa yollar yaratıyoruz ve bunun sayesinde insanların kıymetli zamanını kurtarıyoruz ancak bazen bu kıymetli zaman belki de bir insan için aşamalı gerçekleşecek olan gün içinde ritüel olarak yaptığı bir sıcak içecek belki."

Summary of AI Response

AI clarified that the project should not focus on designing a faster kettle, but on designing the experience of preparing a hot beverage. The discussion reframed the challenge as balancing efficiency and meaningful rituals.

Student Reflection

I realized the project should explore the tension between automation and meaningful daily rituals. Instead of saving time, the design could structure small intentional actions within the beverage preparation process.

Accepted Decisions

Focusing on tea and herbal infusions as the main beverage type.
Investigating ritual behaviors in daily beverage preparation.
Designing an experience rather than a simple appliance.

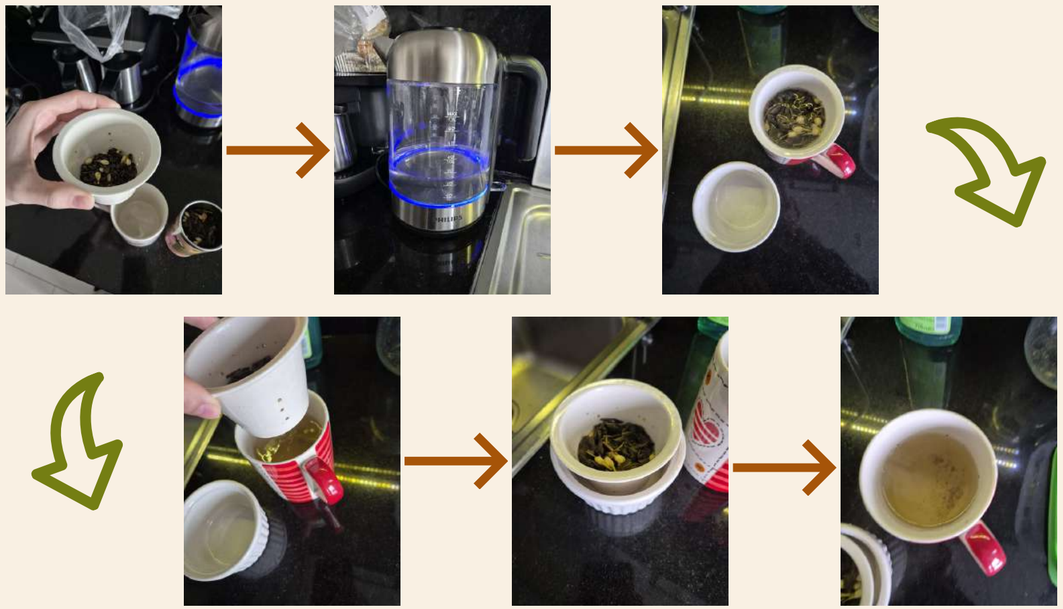
Rejected Decisions:

Coffee-based systems.
Designing purely efficiency-driven appliances.

Reframed Decisions:

Shifted from "saving time" as a goal to "structuring meaningful micro-rituals" within time pressure.

Observations



1 Araştırma Ekseni 1: Kültürel Olarak Sıcak İçecek Ritüelleri

Önce ürün değil, ritüel.

Sıcak içecekler sadece kafein değil; kültür, kimlik, tempo ve kontrol meselesi.

Çay

- **Türkiye:** Sohbet, misafirlik, süreklilik.
- **Japonya (Matcha):** Meditatif, yavaş, kas kontrollü, zihinsel odak.
- **İngiltere:** Sosyal düzen, gün içi mola.
- **Rusya (Samovar):** Kolektif ısınma, uzun süreli birliktelik.

Çay çoğunlukla "akış" ritüelidir.
Hızlı yapılabilir ama çoğu kültürde yavaşlatıcıdır.

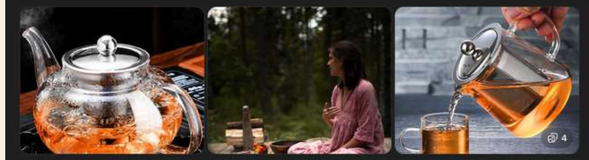
Kahve

- **Espresso bar:** Hız, şehir temposu.
- **Türk kahvesi:** Sabır, bekleme, telve, fal → belirsizlik.
- **Pour-over:** Kontrol, oran, zaman, teknik.
- **Ofis makinesi:** işlevsel, otomatik, duygusuz.

Kahve iki uçta yaşar:

- Performans aracı
- Kontrol/ritüel aracı

Bitki Çayları & İnfüzyonlar



- Sağlık odaklı
- Akşam sakinleşme
- Bireysel, içe dönük

Burada "iyileşme" ve "bedensel farkındalık" var.

2 Araştırma Ekseni 2: Mekân & İhtiyaç

Sıcak içecek aynı kalır ama bağlam değişince anlam değişir.

Mekân	İhtiyaç	Ritüel mi? Hız mı?
Ofis	Uyanmak, üretmek	Hız
Ev sabah	Yumuşak başlangıç	Ritüel
Akşam ev	Sakinleşme	Ritüel
Kütüphane	Odak	Minimal
Coworking	Sosyal tetikleyici	Arada
Tiny house	Alan ekonomisi	Fonksiyon

Milestone 2

Context & Cultural Research

AI Role: Expander

#Cultural Rituals #Psychological Grounding #Sensory Engagement

Selected Key Prompt

> “Dünyadaki insanların çay için ne amaçlı ritüelleri kullanımları ve çeşitleri vardır ve benim projem için hangisini seçmemiz gerekir. dünya üzerinde genel olarak sıcak bitkisel karışım türleri ne kültürleri ne uygulama alanları ne buluşturduğu toplumlar kimler?”

Summary of AI Response

The AI provided a cross-cultural analysis of tea rituals (Turkish, Japanese, British), highlighting that tea preparation serves as a "grounding effect" and a tool for psychological regulation.

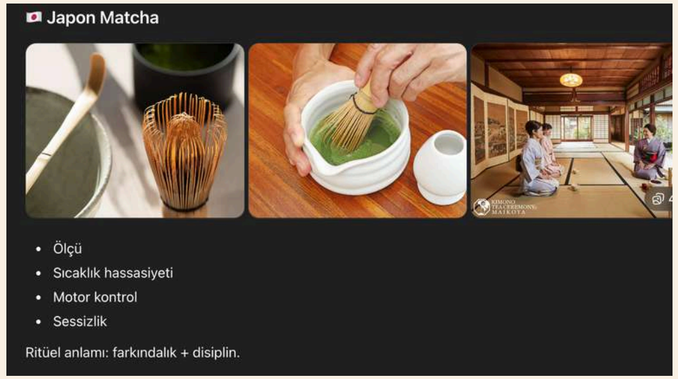
Student Reflection

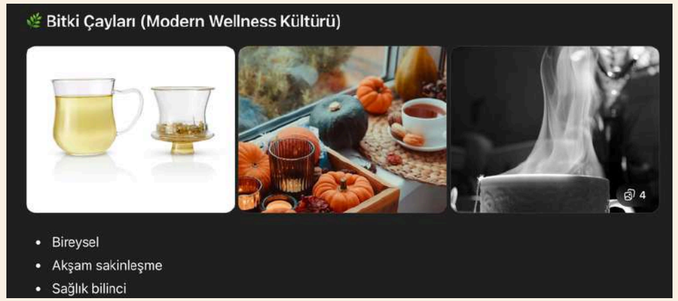
I understood that ritual is not just about physical effort, but about the "sensory ankraj" (grounding) that repetition and motor movements provide to the nervous system.

Accepted Decisions | Incorporating "grounding" elements like visibility of brewing and sensory cues (steam, sound).

Rejected Decisions: | Designing for purely functional performance-boost environments like busy offices.

Reframed Decisions: | Re-evaluating automation not as a replacement for labor, but as a framework that supports user "agency" and control.





- Common Intersection: 6 things that remain constant even as cultures change
- Hot water production (core infrastructure)
- Waiting (the most powerful element of the ritual)
- Level of control (how much the user "does" vs. how much the device "does")
- Sensory signals (steam, sound, smell, light)
- Sharing / individual use (one person or a group?)
- Cleanliness and continuity (brewing waste, reuse, hygiene)

Everyone's tea ritual is different.

Milestone 3

Define

AI Role: Re-framer

#User Agency #Micro-movements #Intentionality

Selected Key Prompt

"kullanıcının yaptığı mikro hareketlerle mi göstermek istiyorsun? Yani şöyle mikro hareketler ama o hareketlerin ardında zihinsel olarak düşünce var. Biz endüstriyelleştirdik ama ruhsuzlaşmasına gerek yok. O boyutta da farklı bir şekilde o ritüeli aslında kişinin zihninde ve yaşadığı duygularla verebiliriz."

Summary of AI Response

The AI suggested that "meaning" cannot be automated, and a successful system must survive even if technology becomes "perfect" by preserving the identity and ritual of the user.

Student Reflection

The designer realized that the framework must allow for "manual overriding" within an automated system to maintain the user's role in the brewing process.

Accepted Decisions | Integrating "user-controlled extraction" as a primary function.

Rejected Decisions: | Fully automatic systems where the user has no participation.

Reframed Decisions: | Developing a "Ritual Map" distinct from a standard "User Journey Map" to track emotional states alongside functional steps.

1. The Benchmark: MoonKettle (Balmuda)

The MoonKettle is the gold standard for "Quiet Tech." It avoids the cluttered look of many electric kettles.

- The Interface: A minimalist base with a digital display hidden under the surface (Dead Front) and a discrete knob.
- Key Functions:
  - Atmospheric Lighting: A gentle "breathing" light that pulses while heating, intended to create a sense of calm.
  - Auditory Cues: Instead of a harsh beep, it uses gentle, chime-like tones to signal "Ready."
  - The "Hold" Button: A simple, dedicated physical button to maintain temperature for 30 minutes.
- UX Design Tip: The UI is almost invisible until touched, keeping the focus on the borosilicate glass vessel.
- Website: Balmuda USA - MoonKettle

2. The "Health Pot" Interface: Buydeem K2683

While slightly more complex, Buydeem is the market leader in borosilicate glass "health pots" (tea + herbal brewing).

- The Interface: A combination of tactile buttons and a progress ring.
- Control Panel Features:
  - 9-in-1 Programs: Instead of just degrees, it has presets for *Flower Tea, Fruit Tea, Soup, and Bird's Nest.*
  - Progress Bar: A circular light-bar that visually fills up as the brewing cycle nears completion.
  - Lid-in-Lid Design: The interface allows you to pause the cycle to add ingredients via the lid without stopping the program.
- UX Design Tip: Use "Programmed Logic." If a user selects "Green Tea," the kettle knows to boil, then cool, then steep.
- Website: Buydeem Global

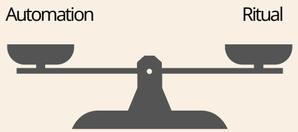
3. The Precision Specialist: Varia Aura Smart Kettle

This is a 2026 favorite for designers because it uses a high-end OLED display integrated into a rotary dial.

- The Interface: A single, large rotary dial with an embedded OLED screen in the center.
- Screen Modes:
  - Real-time PID Tracking: Shows a live graph or digits of the water temperature as it reaches the set point (accurate to 1°C).
  - Smart Wake-up: A scheduling UI that allows you to set a "Ready Time."
  - Steep Timer: Integrated into the dial; once you pour, the screen switches to a countdown.
- UX Design Tip: The "Rotary Dial" is the most intuitive "ritual" input—it mimics the turning of a traditional stove knob.
- Website: Varia Brewing

Core Focus

Tea preparation was chosen as a ritual-rich daily activity. The main design tension became: automation vs meaningful participation.



The project aims to support daily convenience without removing ritual.

The Product Promise

A transparent glass tea maker that preserves ritual through visibility, aroma, and user-controlled extraction. The product reduces friction with temperature control and keep-warm support. It simplifies the boring parts, not the meaningful ones.

- visibility
- extraction control
- keep warm

One Product, Multiple Rituals

Different users prepare tea in different ways. The product supports multiple brewing behaviors instead of forcing one method. This makes it flexible, inclusive, and closer to real tea habits.

- free leaves
- spout filter
- press mode
- lift / extraction stop

Comparison of Design Philosophies

Feature	MoonKettle (Minimalist)	Varia Aura (Pro-Precision)	Buydeem (Functionalist)
Input Type	Click-Dial / Single Button	OLED Rotary Dial	Push Buttons + Knob
Visual Feedback	Ambient Pulse Light	Sharp OLED Data	Light-up Progress Ring
Sound Design	Musical Chimes	Single Soft Beep	Standard Alerts
Materials	Matte Metal / Glass	304 Stainless / Glass	Schott Duran Glass

Recommended Features for Your Product

Since you are designing for Simplicity & Ritual, I suggest these "Essential UX" elements:

1. Dead-Front Display: Ensure the numbers only appear when the kettle is active. This keeps the borosilicate glass as the "hero" of the design.
2. Haptic Rotary Dial: A dial with subtle "clicks" as you turn it feels more premium and traditional than a touch screen.
3. Variable "Hold" Intervals: Instead of just a 30-minute hold, give the user the option via the dial for *30, 60, or 120 mins.*

Milestone 4

User Research

AI Role: Clarifier

#Decision-making #User Feedback #Data-grounded decisions

Selected Key Prompt

"Herkesin bir ürün kullanım şekli var. Ancak belirli konularda bir benzerlik aslında bizim yakalamamız gerekiyor. Bu da benim seninle beraber hazırlayacağım o 15 ya da 20 soruluk test içerisine dair olabilecek bir şey aynı zamanda. Farklı ülke ve farklı kültürlerde de ne çeşit ve ne şekilde yapılıyor."

Summary of AI Response

The AI critiqued the designer's tendency to "ask questions they already know the answer to" and helped formulate a survey to measure "automation thresholds" and "sensory needs".

Student Reflection

The designer recognized the need for objective data to determine which specific steps (like "pre-washing" leaves) users actually value as part of their ritual.

Accepted Decisions

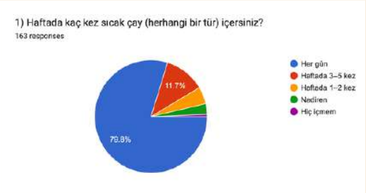
Including "pre-infusion" or "aroma pause" as a dedicated user-selected function.

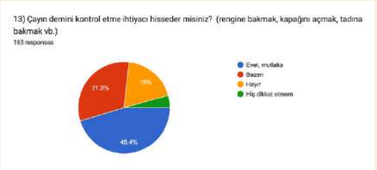
Rejected Decisions:

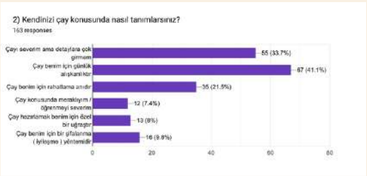
Hardcoding fixed sequences; decided to make certain preparation steps optional.

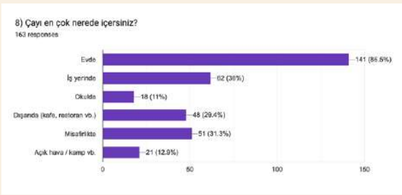
Reframed Decisions:

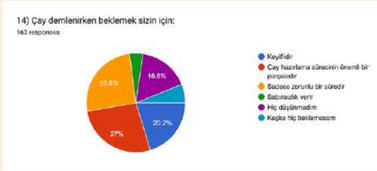
Shifting from "persona-based" design to "lifestyle-based" clusters centered around ritual intensity.

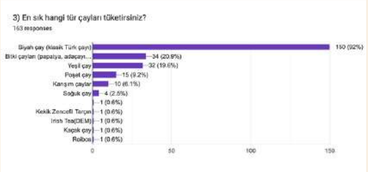


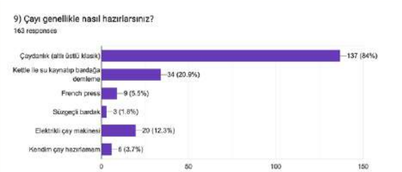


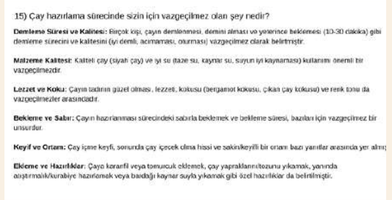











15) Çay hazırlama sürecinde sizin için vazgeçilmez olan şey nedir?

Demleme Süresi ve Kalitesi: Birçok kişi, çayın demlenmesi, demini alması ve yeterince beklemesi (3-30 dakika) gibi demleme sürecini ve kalitesini (iyi demli, acımaması, olurması) vazgeçilmez olarak belirtmiştir.

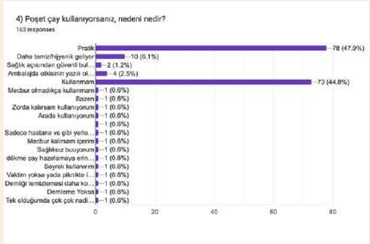
Malzeme Kalitesi: Kaliteli çay (siyah çay) ve iyi su (taze su, kaynar su, suyun iyi kaynaması) kullanımı önemli bir vazgeçilmezdir.

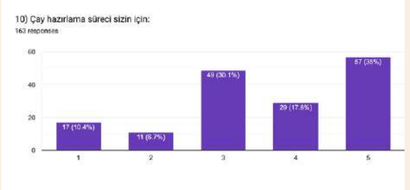
Lezzet ve Koku: Çayın tadının güzel olması, lezzeti, kokusu (bergamot kokusu, çikan çay kokusu) ve renk tonu da vazgeçilmezler arasındadır.

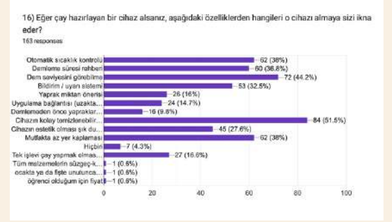
Bekleme ve Sabır: Çayın hazırlanması sürecindeki sabırla beklemek ve bekleme süresi, bazıları için vazgeçilmez bir unsurdur.

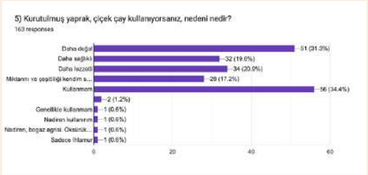
Keyif ve Ortam: Çay içme keyfi, sonunda çay içecek olma hissi ve sakinleşyili bir ortam bazı yanıtlar arasında yer alm

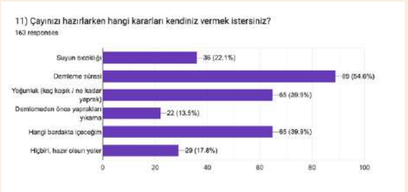
Ekleme ve Hazırlıklar: Çayı kararlı veya tamurcuk eldesek, çay yapraklarınıtozunu yıkamak, yanında atıştırmalık/kurabiye hazırlamak veya bardağı kaynar suyla yıkamak gibi özel hazırlıklar da belirtilmiştir.

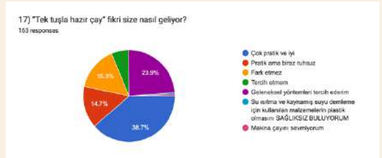


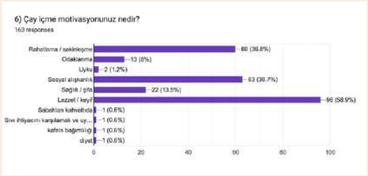


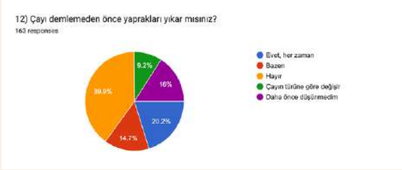












Milestone 5

Market & Product Analysis

AI Role: Clarifier

#Market Saturation #Differentiation #Systems of Meaning

Selected Key Prompt

"Piyasa araştırması yapmak istiyorum. Benim şu an kafamda kurguladığım ürüne benzer diğer ürünleri gözlemlemek bu gibi ürünlerde ürün sistemi içerisinde ne gibi fonksiyonlar kullanılmış. Özellikle yeni çıkan ürünler ve tasarımları ile ilgili bir inceleme yapmak istiyorum."

Summary of AI Response

The AI clarified that while functional features (temperature control, timers) are now "baseline expectations," the design's value comes from its "positioning" and "meaning".

Student Reflection

The designer understood that differentiation wouldn't come from new features, but from a unique form language and a ritual-centered user flow.

Accepted Decisions

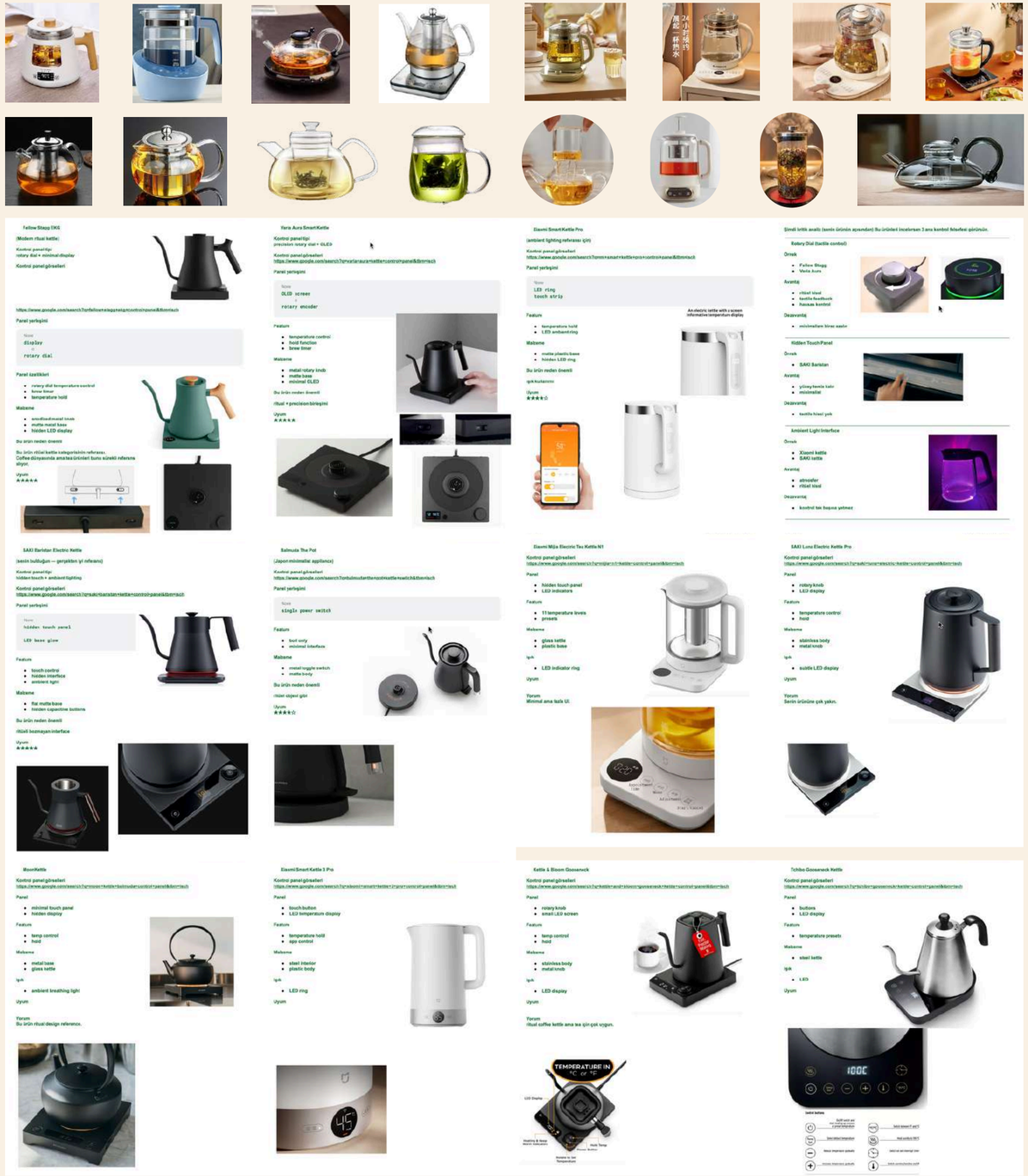
Using high-end "wellness appliance" branding and material palettes like matte ceramic and wood.

Rejected Decisions:

Traditional "teched-out" aesthetic common in office appliances.

Reframed Decisions:

Moving focus from "what the device does" to "how it communicates brewing progress" through light and sound.



Milestone 6

Ideation

AI Role: Clarifier

#Form Language #Inspiration from nature #Water drop metaphor

Selected Key Prompt

"Araştırmada videolarda kurumuş kapkara çayın üzerine sıcak suyu döküp bekletiyor öyle bir yeşeriyor ve açıyor ki o yaprak sanki hiç kurutulmadan ve çay olmadan önceki o tarladaki haline geri dönüyor. Bu bana bir ilham verdi. Ben çay yaprağı üzerinde bir damla gibi olabilir diye düşündüm bence çok güzel bir hikayeleştirme ve esinlenme noktası."

Summary of AI Response

AI expanded this observation into a design narrative, suggesting that the moment of transformation between water and tea leaf could become the core inspiration for the product form and experience.

Student Reflection

This observation helped me see tea preparation as a visual transformation process, not only a functional one. The idea of a water drop interacting with a tea leaf became a strong conceptual inspiration for the design.

Accepted Decisions

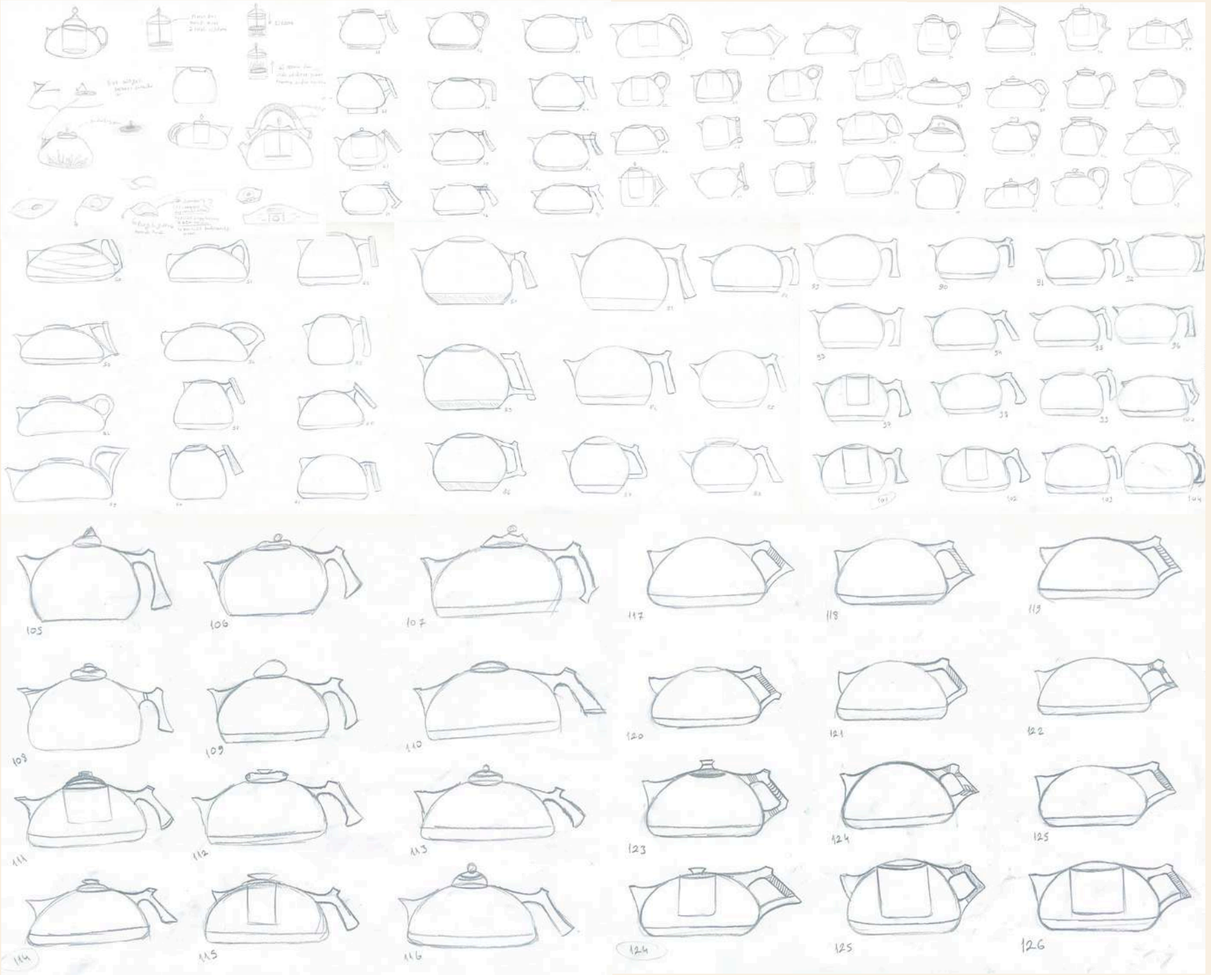
Using the tea leaf transformation as a design inspiration.
Developing a water drop narrative for the concept.
Emphasizing the moment of infusion and change.

Rejected Decisions:

Arbitrary product forms unrelated to tea preparation.
Purely technical appliance aesthetics.

Reframed Decisions:

Tea brewing process → visual transformation narrative.
Product form → water-drop inspired concept.



Milestone 7

AI Visualization

AI Role: Expander

#Concept visualization #Variation Generation #Visual Prompting

Selected Key Prompt

"Şimdi ben böyle bir prototip çalışması yaptım. Bu yağmur damlası formu ve aşağısında da yaprak andıran, vurgulu böyle bir yaprak gibi biraz daha organik bir form tercih ettim."

Summary of AI Response

AI translated the physical clay prototype into structured visualization prompts, progressively increasing the level of detail. These prompts described the product form, materials, proportions, and components, enabling clearer rendering in external visualization tools.

Student Reflection

The clay prototype captured the conceptual form, but its material qualities were unclear. AI helped transform the prototype into a readable product description, making it easier to visualize the design digitally.

Accepted Decisions

Using AI to translate a physical prototype into visualization prompts.
Defining product materials, structure, and proportions through prompt writing.
Generating multiple prompt levels (basic → detailed) for rendering tools.

Rejected Decisions:

Generating product designs only from written prompts.
Allowing AI to significantly alter the original prototype form.

Reframed Decisions:

Clay prototype → AI-interpreted digital concept.
Visual sketch → structured visualization prompt system.

Milestone 8

Prototype

AI Role:Expander

#Mockup development #Physical prototyping #Prototype testing

Selected Key Prompt

"Kapak da gövde ile aynı materyal. Heating base ise pastel yeşil boyalı olacak. Heating base üzerinde gördüğün küçük çember içinde display olacak sıcaklığı gösteren."

Summary of AI Response

AI helped translate the physical mockup into a clear visualization by describing materials, colors and component placement. This allowed the prototype form to be represented as a finished product image.

Student Reflection

Creating a clay prototype allowed me to test the form, proportions and overall structure of the product. The physical mockup helped confirm the organic drop and leaf relationship before moving to final visualizations.

Accepted Decisions

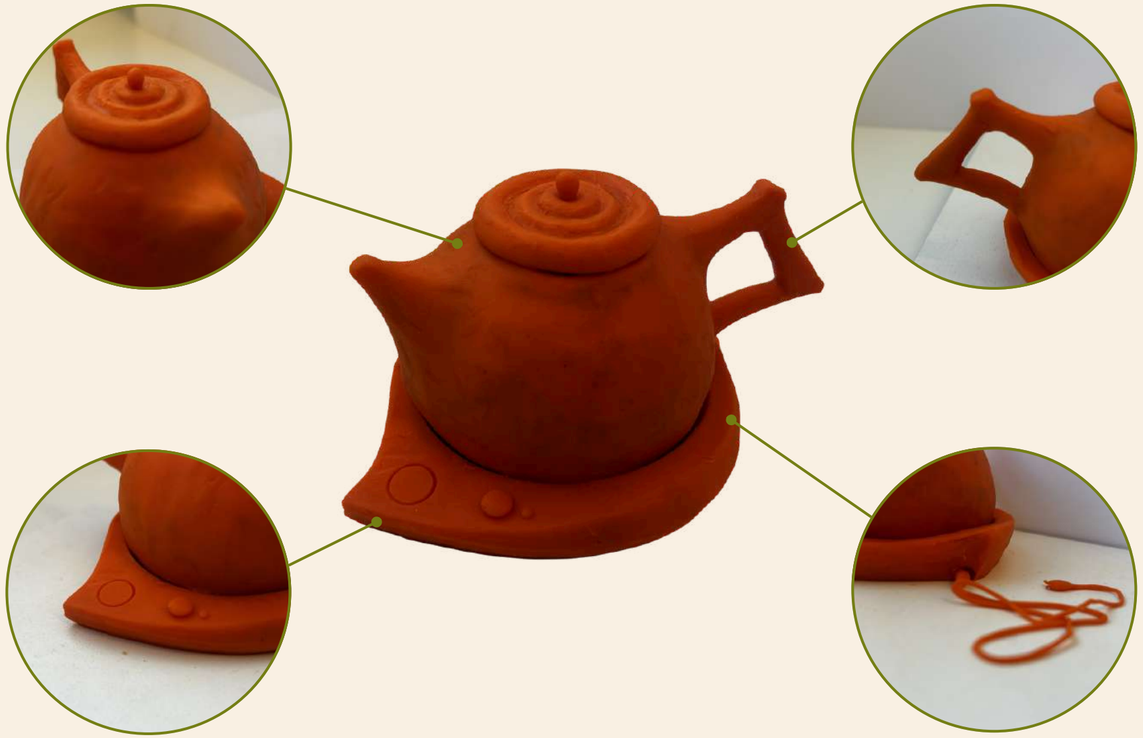
Raindrop-inspired upper form.
Leaf-like organic base geometry.
Pastel green heating base with integrated temperature display.

Rejected Decisions:

Changing the form developed through physical prototyping.
Allowing AI visualization to redefine the product geometry.

Reframed Decisions:

Concept sketches → physical prototype.
Prototype form → refined product structure.



Milestone 9

Detail Design

AI Role: Critique

#Refinement #Component Design #Visual Correction

Selected Key Prompt

"hayır cam silindirin içindeki metalik süzgeç silindirin dibinde olucak alt kısımda yapraklar onun üzerinde konumlanıcak silindirin devamı ise sana attığım görseldeki gibi cam silindir olarak kalacak"

Summary of AI Response

AI refined the internal structure of the product by clarifying the position and function of the metal filter inside the glass chamber. This helped define the brewing mechanism and ensured the internal components matched the intended preparation process.

Student Reflection

The designer realized that "AI hallucinations" in component placement required manual over-painting in Procreate to ensure mechanical feasibility.

Accepted Decisions | A "metal rod connected to a base strainer" mechanism.

Rejected Decisions: | Standard floating mesh filters that obscured the "blooming tea" visual.

Reframed Decisions: | Redesigning the lid to integrate the "press-infuser" mechanism more realistically.

Milestone 10

Final Renders

AI Role: Expander

#Contextual Visualization *#Interaction Detail* *#High-end Product Rendering*

Selected Key Prompt

> “Ultra realistic product render showing two electric glass teapots with identical geometry and composition as the reference image...”

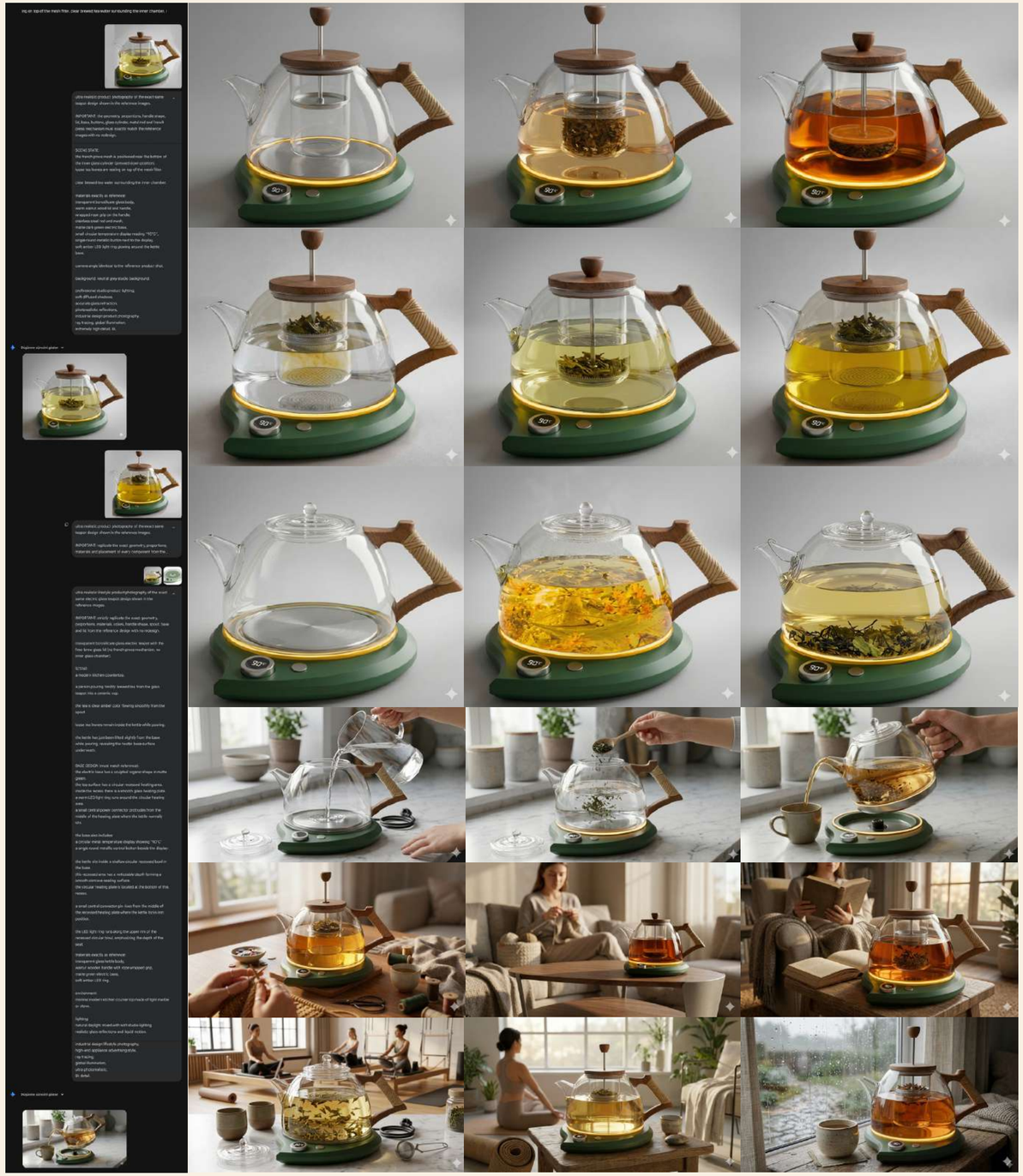
Summary of AI Response

The AI produced high-fidelity visuals showing the "blooming" process and the "amber transition" of the LED light, effectively communicating the intended "calm" atmosphere.

Student Reflection

The final visuals successfully communicated that the product is a "ritual tool" for "wellness," rather than just another kitchen appliance.

Accepted Decisions | "Hidden-until-lit" interface with a single tactile rotary dial.

Rejected Decisions: | Busy digital screens; opting instead for subtle ambient LED glows.

Reframed Decisions: | Finalized the base as a "matte warm ceramic" unit that serves as a charging station and visual anchor.